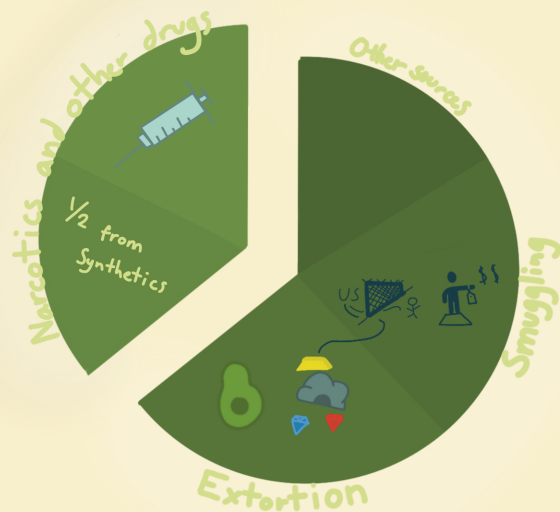


# Mexico

## COLLEGE 105 Issues with Organized Crime

For decades Mexico has struggled with powerful criminal organizations crippling the country. The problem has only escalated over the past few decades, particularly when the Mexican war on drugs began in 2006. The power cartels have on local development varies around the country, but they continue to disrupt elections and fuel corruption within the government. While the cartels are able to generate anywhere from 30-40 billion dollars in drug sales every year, they pull young men out of the workforce (with the average member joining when they are 13-15 years old) and lead them down a life of crime and danger. The lawlessness created by cartels not only hampers the Mexican government's ability to govern but also contributes to crises in neighboring countries like the US.

## Cartel Revenue Sources



## Abrazos no Balazos

Mexican President López Obrador's policy on gangs, "hugs not bullets," seeks to address the root cause of young men joining cartels, however it does little to confront existing gangs allowing them to expand. The previous war on drugs caused gangs to splinter to over 200 from only 76 in 2010. However few are able to make or traffick drugs

## US Travel Advisories

Based on crime rates



Record High

**33,341** Drug-Related Homicides  
In 2018

The last election had over **543** politicians:

**Extorted**  
**Kidnapped**  
**Assassinated**  
In 22 of 31 States

**48** Candidates  
**84** Party Workers

**28**  
Murders per 100,000  
**3x**  
Increase since 2006